

The Loneliest Girl: Five-Minute Drills

Nine drills for one song, from locking to the tempo to playing the melody over your own left hand

What this set is for

One target: play **The Loneliest Girl** (Carole & Tuesday) at the keyboard with both hands, at the record's tempo, with the form in your head.

On the way you pick up the pop-piano toolkit the song is built from: chord shapes that barely move, a left hand that keeps time, the push, broken chords, and finding a melody by ear.

The melody notes are not written out here. Learn them from licensed sheet music or a tutorial. Drill 9 gets your ear and right hand ready so that goes quickly.

The song at a glance

Key	G major (one sharp: F#)
Tempo	about 112 BPM, 4/4
Chords	Em, C, G, Bm, D, Am (six in all)
Verse	Em – C – G – Bm
Pre-chorus	C – G – Em – D, C – G – Am – D
Chorus	C – G – Em – D, ends C – D – G

Chord charts online disagree in details. Treat this as the skeleton and check it against the recording; Drill 1 has you count the bars yourself.

The daily routine

1. **Set a 5-minute timer.** Stop when it rings, even if it's going well.
2. **One front drill:** the lowest one whose gate you haven't ticked. With 10 minutes, add one review drill.
3. **Follow "The 5 minutes"** on the page. The last minute is always playing, and most days that means playing some of the song.

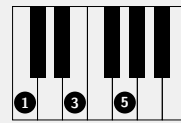
Three rules

1. **Count out loud.** "One and two and..." Every time.
2. **Metronome ladder.** Start where you make no mistakes. 3 clean runs: add 5 BPM. Two stumbles in a row: drop 5 BPM.
3. **Slow and clean beats fast and messy.** Your hands learn whatever you repeat, mistakes included.

When to go back

If hands together (Drills 6–7) falls apart, the gap is nearly always in the chord shapes (3–4) or the left hand (5). Spend a few days there.

How to read the pages



● black dot = press this key. The label is a **finger**, a **scale step**, or R/3/5 (root, third, fifth).

▲ triangle = the **root** or home note.

Fingers: 1 = thumb ... 5 = pinky, both hands.

Chord symbols: G = G major, Em = E minor, Bm = B minor.

Roman numerals number the chords of the key: I = the chord on step 1 (G), vi = the chord on step 6 (Em). Capitals are major, small letters minor. Drill 2 explains it.

Rhythm grids split a 4/4 bar into 8 slots:

1 & 2 & 3 & 4 &
● — • ● — • ● —

● = play, — = keep holding, • = nothing new. This one is 3-3-2 (Drill 6).

The map

#	Drill	What it gives you	Gate
1	Lock to 112	steady pulse, counting, the song's form	L4
2	The Six Chords	G major, thirds, the six chords	L4
3	Lazy Hands: Verse	inversions, smooth changes	L4
4	Lazy Hands: Chorus	pre-chorus, chorus, the ending	L4
5	The Left Hand	bass patterns at 112	L4
6	Hands Together	left hand straight, right hand 3-3-2	L4
7	The Push	chords half a beat early	L4
8	Broken Chords	intro and quiet-verse texture	L4
9	Melody by Ear	pentatonic, chord tones, finding notes	L4

The last page, **Put It Together**, has the song map to fill in, five versions of the song to climb, and the progress log.

Typical path

Weeks 1–2: Drills 1, 2, 3. **Weeks 3–4:** 4 and 5. You can play the whole song as chords now. **Weeks 5–7:** 6 and 7, the groove. **Weeks 8+:** 8 and 9, then the melody. Drill 1 stays as a one-minute warm-up throughout. Slower is fine.

Kit

Metronome app, the recording, and a phone or DAW to record yourself. Sustain pedal if you have one.

Lock to 112

DRILL

1

The song moves at about 112 beats per minute. Get that pulse into your body before any chords.

Needs: nothing **Skills:** pulse, 8th notes, hearing beat 1, the form **Gate:** L4

Why this matters

Every other drill assumes you can count “1 & 2 & 3 & 4 &” without drifting. 112 BPM is a medium pop tempo: too fast to think between beats, slow enough that 8th notes stay under control. Beginners rush the easy bars and drag at the chord changes, and a metronome catches both. The listening half of this drill matters as much as the clapping half. Once you can hear where each bar starts on the recording, you can count how long each section is, and you stop getting lost in the song.

Six patterns

	1	&	2	&	3	&	4	&
A Quarters	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•
B Eighth	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•
C Halves	•	—	—	—	•	—	—	—
D 3-3-2	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•
E Backbeat	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•
F The push	•	•	•	•	•	•	•	•

How to play a pattern: clap it, or tap one key (G), while counting every slot out loud.

C is the feel of the quiet sections. **D** is the groove for Drill 6.

E is where the snare drum usually sits. Clap it along with the record.

F: the hit on 4& already belongs to the next bar. Hold it through the next beat 1 and don't replay it. Drill 7 is built on this.

Map the song

Play the recording and tap quarter notes on your leg. Say “one” loudly on the first beat of each bar and count bars: “one-2-3-4, two-2-3-4...” Write how many bars each section lasts in the song map on the last page. Most pop sections are 4 or 8 bars. If you get 7 or 9, count that section again.

The 5 minutes

0:00–1:00

Pulse. Metronome at 80. Pattern A, then B, 2 bars each, counting aloud.

1:00–2:30

Pattern of the day (C, D, E or F), 8 bars. Then 8 bars switching between A and that pattern every 2 bars.

2:30–4:00

With the recording. Tap A along with the song. Say beat 1 of every bar louder.

4:00–5:00

Map one section. Count its bars and write the number on the last page.

Level ladder — stay on a level for days or weeks; tick it when you play it clean 3 times in a row

☐ L1 Patterns A, B, D, counting aloud, no stops	80	_____
☐ L2 All six patterns	90	_____
☐ L3 A and B at the song's tempo	112	_____
☐ L4 Gate. All six at 112, switching pattern every 4 bars	112	_____
☐ L5 Tap along with the whole recording without losing beat 1	record	_____
☐ L6 Bar counts for every section written on the last page	—	_____
☐ L7 Metronome at 56, heard as clicks on 2 and 4 only; clap B against it	112	_____

Make it harder

Tap A with your foot and clap D with your hands. Record yourself clapping to the metronome in a DAW and zoom in on the grid: are you early or late?

In the recording

Which instrument plays 8ths (B)? Does anything hit early (F)? Write what you hear: _____

The Six Chords

DRILL

2

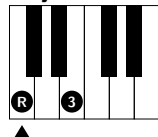
The whole song uses six chords from the key of G. Build each one from thirds.

Needs: Drill 1 L1 **Skills:** G major, thirds, major vs minor, chord numbers **Gate:** L4

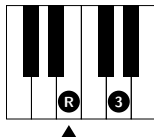
Why this matters

G major uses the notes G A B C D E F $\sharp$: the white keys plus F $\sharp$. Stack two thirds on any of them (skip a note, skip a note) and you get a chord of the key; do it on every step and you get the staircase below. The song uses six of those seven chords. The **third** is what you train here. A **major third is 4 half steps** (bright), a **minor third is 3** (dark). A major chord is a major third with a minor third on top; a minor chord is the reverse. Once you hear that difference, Em vs G or Bm vs D stops being a guess.

Major 3rd: C to E = 4 half steps



Minor 3rd: E to G = 3 half steps

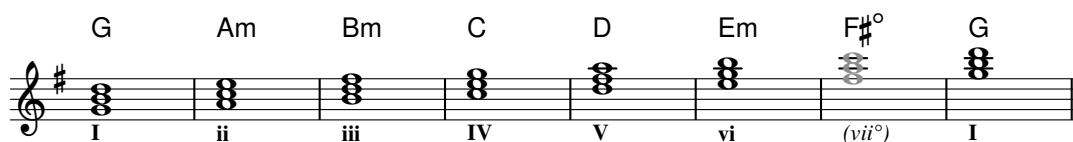


Major chord = 4 + 3 half steps.

Minor chord = 3 + 4.

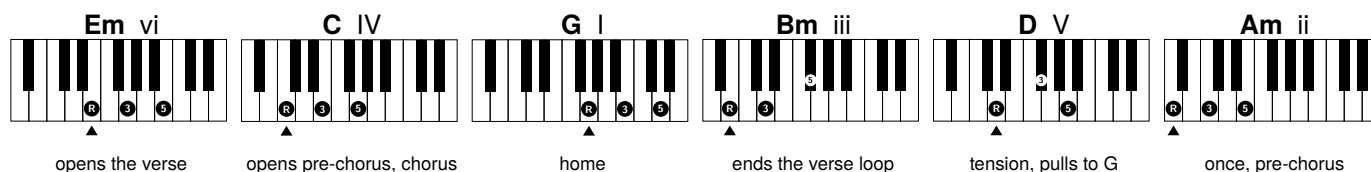
Count the black keys too.

The staircase in G (right hand, fingers 1-3-5)



The grey chord (F $\sharp$ °) is the one the song never uses.

The six song chords



opens the verse

opens pre-chorus, chorus

home

ends the verse loop

tension, pulls to G

once, pre-chorus

Bm and D both contain F $\sharp$, the black key. Most mistakes on this page are a missed F $\sharp$.

The 5 minutes

0:00–1:00

Hear the thirds. Play G–B, A–C, B–D, C–E, D–F $\sharp$, E–G together. Say “bright” or “dark”, then count half steps to check.

1:00–2:30

Staircase up and down in G. Say each name and number: “G one, A minor two...”

2:30–4:00

Chord quiz. Say one of the six at random, play it within 2 seconds. Right hand, then left hand (fingers 5-3-1).

4:00–5:00

Play the verse chords Em–C–G–Bm in root position, one per bar, with the recording or at 70. Blocky is fine today; Drill 3 smooths it.

Level ladder — stay on a level for days or weeks; tick it when you play it clean 3 times in a row

☐ L1 Staircase in G, right hand, naming each chord	60	_____
☐ L2 Same with the left hand	60	_____
☐ L3 The six song chords from the diagrams, eyes on the page	60	_____
☐ L4 Gate. Quiz: any of the six within 2 seconds, either hand	—	_____
☐ L5 Say each chord’s three notes aloud without playing	—	_____
☐ L6 Ear test: have an app play G or Em, D or Bm at random; name it	—	_____
☐ L7 Same numbers in D major: Bm, G, D, F $\sharp$ m, A, Em	60	_____

Make it harder

Play each chord one note at a time and sing the notes. Find all six in the shapes Drill 3 uses before you get there.

In the recording

The verse circles vi–IV–I–iii. It starts on the sad chord (Em) and never settles on G. That is a large part of why the song sounds lonely. The chorus starts on IV and leans toward G.

Lazy Hands: the Verse

DRILL

3

Move each finger to the nearest note. Played this way, the verse needs almost no hand movement.

Needs: Drill 2 L4 **Skills:** inversions, voice leading, changing chords without looking **Gate:** L4

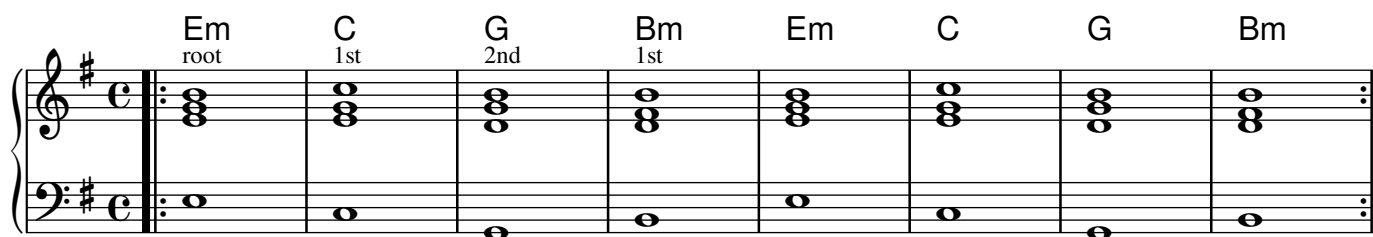
Why this matters

A chord's three notes can be stacked in any order. **Root position** has the root at the bottom (E-G-B). **1st inversion** has the 3rd at the bottom (C as E-G-C). **2nd inversion** has the 5th at the bottom (G as D-G-B). Played in root position, every change in the verse is a jump of the whole hand (top line). Voiced the lazy way (bottom line), the hand stays put and only one or two fingers move at each change. It's easier to play and it sounds smoother. The left hand plays the root, so the chord name stays clear.

Blocky: don't practise this



Lazy: the verse loop you practise (vi-IV-I-iii)



What moves at each change

Em → C top finger: B up to C
 C → G E down to D, C down to B; G stays
 G → Bm middle finger: G down to F#
 Bm → Em D up to E, F# up to G; B stays

Fingers (right hand)

Em (E-G-B): 1-3-5 C (E-G-C): 1-2-5
 G (D-G-B): 1-3-5 Bm (D-F#-B): 1-2-5

Left hand: one low note, the root: E, C, G, B.

The 5 minutes

0:00–1:00

Inversion climb on G: G-B-D, B-D-G, D-G-B, and back. Then the same on Em. Say "root, first, second".

1:00–3:00

Verse loop, lazy shapes, one chord per bar, left-hand roots, at 70. Look at the page, not your hands.

3:00–4:00

Changes only. Each pair back and forth 4 times: Em↔C, C↔G, G↔Bm, Bm↔Em.

4:00–5:00

Play the verse with the recording (or at 90), whole notes. Only goal: land every change on beat 1.

Level ladder — stay on a level for days or weeks; tick it when you play it clean 3 times in a row

☐ L1 Right hand alone, lazy shapes	70	_____
☐ L2 Add left-hand whole-note roots	70	_____
☐ L3 All four back-and-forth changes clean	80	_____
☐ L4 Gate. Verse loop 4× without stopping, eyes on the page	90	_____
☐ L5 Same at the song's tempo	112	_____
☐ L6 Eyes closed	90	_____
☐ L7 Start from another shape of Em (G-B-E or B-E-G) and find the nearest shape of each chord yourself	70	_____

Make it harder

Two chords per bar. Left hand in octaves. Move the loop to C major (Am–F–C–Em) using the same finger moves.

In the recording

Listen to the intro: block chords or one note at a time (broken)? Write it down: _____. Drill 8 covers the broken version.

Lazy Hands: Pre-Chorus and Chorus

DRILL

4

The rest of the song uses the same hand position, plus D and Am.

Needs: Drill 3 L4 **Skills:** the V chord, section changes, the ending **Gate:** L4

Why this matters

The pre-chorus and chorus reuse three verse chords (C, G, Em) in the same shapes and add **D** (V) and **Am** (ii). D is the tension chord of G major: it pulls back toward G, so each line that ends on D sounds like a question the next line has to answer. The ending turns that pull into a full stop: **C – D – G** (IV–V–I), the strongest landing in the key. In these shapes the top notes step C–B–B–A, a small inner melody you can bring out. Section changes are where people stumble, so drill them on their own.

pre-chorus C G Em D C G Am D
IV – I – vi – V, IV – I – ii – V

chorus C G Em D C G Em D C D G
IV – I – vi – V ending IV – V – I

Am is E-A-C here, so it stays close to C and G. Fingers: C 1-2-5, G 1-3-5, Em 1-3-5, D (D-F#-A) 1-3-5, Am 1-3-5. Check the chorus length against your bar count from Drill 1; many choruses repeat the loop before the ending.

The four section changes

Verse → pre-chorus	Bm → C	all three fingers step up: D→E, F#→G, B→C
Pre-chorus → chorus	D → C	D→E, F#→G, A→C
Chorus → verse	D → Em	all three step up: D→E, F#→G, A→B
The ending	C → D → G	down, then G lands with the top note on B

The 5 minutes

0:00–1:00

Warm-up: verse loop once in lazy shapes.

1:00–2:30

Pre-chorus twice, then **chorus** twice, at 70, left-hand whole-note roots.

2:30–4:00

Section changes. Last bar of one section plus first bar of the next, 4× each, from the table above.

4:00–5:00

Verse → **pre-chorus** → **chorus** → **ending** in one go, with the recording or at 90.

Level ladder — stay on a level for days or weeks; tick it when you play it clean 3 times in a row

- | | |
|---|-----------|
| ☐ L1 Pre-chorus, right hand alone | 70 _____ |
| ☐ L2 Chorus and ending, both hands | 70 _____ |
| ☐ L3 All four section changes clean | 80 _____ |
| ☐ L4 Gate. Verse, pre-chorus, chorus, ending without stopping, eyes on the page | 90 _____ |
| ☐ L5 Same at the song's tempo | 112 _____ |
| ☐ L6 Whole form from memory, using your bar counts | 100 _____ |
| ☐ L7 Dsus4 → D (D-G-A, then D-F#-A) on the last D of each pre-chorus line | 90 _____ |

Make it harder

Try Am as A-C-E instead of E-A-C: which sounds closer to the record? Play the chorus with the top note slightly louder than the other two.

In the recording

The chorus is where the song opens up. What changes: a busier bass, louder or higher chords, drums? Write it:

_____. Drills 5–7 give you the tools to copy it.

The Left Hand

DRILL

5

At the keyboard the left hand does the bass player's job. At 112 it has to run by itself.

Needs: Drill 3 L2 **Skills:** bass patterns, 8th-note drive, approach notes **Gate:** L4

Why this matters

The left hand plays the root, so the chord name is clear, and it sets the pulse. Quiet sections want long notes (B1, B2). The chorus wants motion (B3, B4, B5). B6 adds **approach notes**: on beat 4 the left hand steps toward the next root, so the bass walks into each chord change instead of jumping. Practise the left hand alone until it runs without your attention. That spare attention is exactly what hands together needs in Drills 6 and 7.

Six patterns (shown on Em; follow the roots E – C – G – B round the loop)

Fingers: B2: 5 on the root, 1 on the 5th. B4: 5-2-1-2. B5: 5 on the low note, 1 on the high. B6: beat 4 with whichever finger is next to the new root. Chorus roots: C, G, E, D.

The 5 minutes

0:00–1:00	B1 and B2 round the verse loop at 80. Every note the same volume.
1:00–3:00	Pattern of the day (B3, B4, B5 or B6) round the verse loop, then the chorus loop. Count out loud.
3:00–4:00	Energy switch. 4 bars of B2 on the verse, then 4 bars of B3 on the chorus. That's the song's lift in one hand.
4:00–5:00	With the recording. Left hand only, choosing a pattern for each section.

Level ladder — stay on a level for days or weeks; tick it when you play it clean 3 times in a row

☐ L1 B1 and B2 round the verse loop	80	_____
☐ L2 B3 and B4 on the verse and chorus loops	80	_____
☐ L3 B5 octaves	90	_____
☐ L4 Gate. 8 bars of B2 on the verse, then 8 of B3 on the chorus, no break	112	_____
☐ L5 B6 approach notes on the verse loop	90	_____
☐ L6 Whole form, left hand only, with the recording	record	_____
☐ L7 Invent your own 1-bar bass rhythm and loop it for 8 bars	any	_____

Make it harder

Play B3 short (staccato), then smooth (legato). Record the left hand into a DAW on a bass synth and loop it under the drums: that's a backing track.

In the recording

Find the real bass line: bass guitar or the piano's left hand. Does it stay on roots or move between them? Hum it, then find it on the keys, starting from B6.

Hands Together

DRILL

6

Left hand in straight time, right hand playing a rhythm against it. This is the core skill of the song.

Needs: Drill 4 L4, Drill 5 L4 **Skills:** hand independence, 3-3-2 against quarters **Gate:** L4

Why this matters

Hands together is two skills at once, so build it in steps where one hand is already automatic. The notated version (S4) has the right hand playing **3-3-2** (on 1, 2&, 4) while the left hand plays straight quarters. The right hand's second chord lands on the "&" of 2, between two left-hand notes, and that is the moment that falls apart first. Count out loud the whole time; counting holds the two hands together. If it falls apart, drop 10 BPM. Don't drop the counting.

S4: right hand 3-3-2, left hand quarters (verse loop)

The steps

	Left hand	Right hand	Note
S1	whole notes	quarters	the easy start
S2	quarters	quarters	both hands together on every beat
S3	whole notes	3-3-2	the right hand's rhythm on its own
S4	quarters	3-3-2	shown above; the target for the verse
S5	B3 8ths	3-3-2	chorus energy

Your own groove

If the verse on the recording doesn't sound like 3-3-2, tap the rhythm you hear and write it here. Use it in S3–S5 in place of 3-3-2.

	1	&	2	&	3	&	4	&
verse								
chorus								

The 5 minutes

0:00–1:00	Hands separately. Left hand quarters round the verse loop; right hand 3-3-2 round the loop. Count aloud.
1:00–3:00	Step of the day: the lowest step you haven't ticked. Verse loop, 4 rounds.
3:00–4:00	Same step on the chorus loop (C–G–Em–D).
4:00–5:00	Play verse into chorus with any step you own, with the recording or at a tempo you can hold.

Level ladder — stay on a level for days or weeks; tick it when you play it clean 3 times in a row

☐ L1 S1 and S2, verse loop	70	_____
☐ L2 S3, verse loop	70	_____
☐ L3 S4, verse loop	80	_____
☐ L4 Gate. S4 on the verse and chorus loops, 4× each	100	_____
☐ L5 S4 at the song's tempo	112	_____
☐ L6 S5 on the chorus	100	_____
☐ L7 Whole form: S4 on verse and pre-chorus, S5 on the chorus	112	_____

Make it harder

Try it at 60: slow tempos expose timing more than fast ones. Accent the right hand's beat 1, then its 2&, then its 4.

In the recording

Pop records often keep the left hand simple and put the rhythm in the right hand, or the reverse. Which hand (or instrument) carries the rhythm here?

The Push

DRILL

7

Play the next chord half a beat early. It's the small move that makes pop piano sound like pop.

Needs: Drill 6 L3 **Skills:** anticipation, ties across the bar line, syncopation **Gate:** L4

Why this matters

A **push** (or anticipation) plays the next chord on the "&" of 4, half a beat before the bar line, and holds it through beat 1. The left hand does *not* push: it plays the new root on beat 1 as usual. So for half a beat the right hand is already on the new chord while the bass is still on the old one, and then the bass catches up. That small overlap is what makes a push feel like forward motion. Most pop songs push some chord changes and not others, usually more in the chorus. Learn it as a switch you can flip for each bar, then set the switches by ear to match the recording.

Every change pushed (verse loop)

The right hand plays beat 1, then the next chord on 4& and holds it across the bar line (the tie). On beat 1 of the next bar the right hand plays nothing new. The left hand plays half notes on 1 and 3. When the loop repeats, bar 1's beat 1 is tied too, so stay silent there.

Counting a push

Say the push out loud: "1 – 2 – 3 – 4 **PUSH** (hold) 2 – 3 – 4 **PUSH**..." The word lands on the "&". If your hand replays the chord on beat 1, you're still thinking of beat 1 as the start of the chord; the count fixes that.

The 5 minutes

0:00–1:00

Clap pattern F from Drill 1, saying "push" on 4&.

1:00–2:30

One push only. Verse loop with whole-note chords; push only the change back to Em (Bm → Em).

2:30–4:00

Every change pushed, as written, at 70–80.

4:00–5:00

Chorus loop by ear. Push the changes you hear pushed on the recording; play the rest on beat 1.

Level ladder — stay on a level for days or weeks; tick it when you play it clean 3 times in a row

☐ L1 Pattern F clapped, counting aloud	90 _____
☐ L2 One push per loop, both hands	70 _____
☐ L3 All pushes, right hand alone	80 _____
☐ L4 Gate. All pushes, both hands, verse loop 4×	90 _____
☐ L5 Chorus loop with pushes	100 _____
☐ L6 Switch at will: no pushes in the verse, pushes in the chorus	112 _____
☐ L7 Right hand on 1, 2&, and a push on 4&, left hand on 1 and 3	100 _____

Make it harder

Push with both hands, so the bass jumps early too. That's a band "hit". Compare the two: which one suits the chorus?

In the recording

Mark the chord changes that are pushed. Section and chord:

Broken Chords

DRILL

8

Play the chord one note at a time. For the intro, a soft verse, or your own lo-fi version.

Needs: Drill 3 L4 **Skills:** right-hand arpeggios, even 8ths, pedalling **Gate:** L4

Why this matters

Not every section wants struck chords. Break a chord into single notes (an **arpeggio**) and one held harmony becomes a flowing line of 8ths. It suits an intro and a quiet first verse, and it's what a synth arpeggiator automates. Use the lazy shapes from Drill 3 so the hand barely moves. The left hand holds the root and the pedal blends the notes into one chord. Change the pedal exactly as the chord changes: lift and press again as you play the new bass note, or the old chord smears into the new one.

P1 up-down, verse loop

Em C G Bm

Fingers: Em and G 1-3-5-3; C and Bm 1-2-5-2. Keep the 8ths even; the top note is the one people rush.

Four patterns

- P1 up-down bottom – middle – top – middle, twice per bar (shown)
P2 up only bottom – middle – top – (rest), a more open sound
P3 rocking bottom – top – middle – top, a ballad pattern
P4 roll roll the chord from bottom to top on beat 1 and let it ring for the bar

The 5 minutes

0:00–1:00

P1 on Em alone, 8ths at 70, perfectly even.

1:00–3:00

Pattern of the day round the verse loop with left-hand roots and pedal.

3:00–4:00

Mix. 2 bars broken, 2 bars block chords, round and round.

4:00–5:00

Your intro. Verse loop twice, broken and soft, then into the verse with block chords.

Level ladder — stay on a level for days or weeks; tick it when you play it clean 3 times in a row

- | | | |
|---|-----|-------|
| ☐ L1 P1 round the verse loop, right hand alone | 70 | _____ |
| ☐ L2 Add left-hand roots and pedal | 70 | _____ |
| ☐ L3 P3 rocking | 80 | _____ |
| ☐ L4 Gate. P1 or P3, verse loop 4×, clean pedal changes | 90 | _____ |
| ☐ L5 Chorus loop broken | 90 | _____ |
| ☐ L6 Swing the 8ths (long-short) for a lo-fi version | 80 | _____ |
| ☐ L7 Intro (broken) → verse (block, Drill 6) → chorus (pushes, Drill 7) | 112 | _____ |

Make it harder

Left hand plays B4 (root-5-8-5) under right-hand P1, so both hands are broken. Record it into a DAW, then try it on an electric piano or pad sound.

In the recording

If the intro on the record is broken, match it: which note comes first? 8ths or 16ths? Write it:

Melody by Ear

DRILL

9

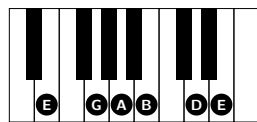
Get your ear and right hand ready for the tune, then learn it from a licensed source.

Needs: Drill 2 L4 **Skills:** E minor pentatonic, chord tones, finding notes by ear **Gate:** L4

Why this matters

The melody isn't written out here: learn the exact notes from licensed sheet music or a tutorial. This drill makes that go faster. The melody is in G major, and **E minor pentatonic** (E G A B D) is a five-note set from that scale with no clashes over any verse chord, so it's a safe space for improvising. Melodies tend to land on **chord tones** on strong beats. Know the three notes of each chord and you have three good first guesses for any note you're trying to find. Finding notes by ear is slow at first and speeds up quickly. It's also the skill behind writing your own melodies.

E minor pentatonic



Fingers: E-G-A 1-2-3, thumb under, B-D-E 1-2-3.

Target notes (chord tones)



When you lose a note, try these three first.

Phrase finder

Play one phrase of the recording, pause, sing its first note, then find it on the keys. Start with the chord tones of the chord underneath. Write what you find.

Section	Phrase	First note	Longest note	Chord under it
verse	1			
verse	2			
pre-chorus	1			
pre-chorus	2			
chorus	1			
chorus	2			

The 5 minutes

0:00–1:00

E minor pentatonic up and down, right hand, saying the note names.

1:00–2:30

Improvise. Left hand plays B1 roots round the verse loop; right hand uses only pentatonic notes. End every 4 bars on E, G or B.

2:30–4:00

Phrase finder. One or two phrases a day, into the table.

4:00–5:00

The melody so far, from your sheet or tutorial: right hand alone at 80, phrase by phrase.

Level ladder — stay on a level for days or weeks; tick it when you play it clean 3 times in a row

☐ L1 E minor pentatonic, one octave, right hand	70	_____
☐ L2 Two octaves, up and down	80	_____
☐ L3 Improvise 8 bars over the verse loop, ending on a chord tone	80	_____
☐ L4 Gate. Phrase finder filled in for verse and chorus	—	_____
☐ L5 Verse and chorus melody, right hand alone	80	_____
☐ L6 Melody with left-hand B1 roots	80	_____
☐ L7 Melody with left-hand B2 or B3	112	_____

Make it harder

Sing the melody while playing the chords from Drill 4. Enter a phrase into a DAW piano roll from memory, then compare it with the record.

In the recording

Singers phrase ahead of and behind the beat. Learn the notes straight, on the grid, first. Copy the looseness from the recording last.

Put It Together

Fill in the map from the recording, then climb the five versions of the song.

Song map

Bar counts come from Drill 1. The recording may have more sections than listed (a second verse, a bridge, an outro); add them in the empty rows. Your notes win over this page wherever they disagree.

Section	Chords	Bars	Right hand (drill)	Left hand (Drill 5)
Intro	Em C G Bm		broken chords (8)	B1 roots
Verse	Em C G Bm		3-3-2 (6)	B2 root–5th
Pre-chorus	C G Em D, C G Am D		3-3-2 (6)	B2, then B3
Chorus	C G Em D ...		pushes (7)	B3 8ths or B5 octaves
Ending	C D G		held chords	B1 roots

Five versions of the song

Each version is a complete performance. Play V1 all the way through before you add anything.

Level ladder — stay on a level for days or weeks; tick it when you play it clean 3 times in a row		
☐ V1 Chords. Lazy shapes, whole notes, left-hand roots, whole form without stopping (Drills 3–4)	90	_____
☐ V2 Groove. Verse on S4, chorus with pushes and B3 8ths (Drills 5–7)	112	_____
☐ V3 Accompaniment. V2 with a broken-chord intro; hum or sing the melody over it (Drill 8)	112	_____
☐ V4 Melody. Melody in the right hand, left hand B1 or B2 (Drill 9)	80–112	_____
☐ V5 Play along with the recording from start to finish	record	_____

Progress log (write the date when you tick a level)

Drill	L1	L2	L3	L4	L5	L6	L7
1 Lock to 112							
2 The Six Chords							
3 Lazy Hands: Verse							
4 Lazy Hands: Chorus							
5 The Left Hand							
6 Hands Together							
7 The Push							
8 Broken Chords							
9 Melody by Ear							